DAY 1 - BEGINNER

Spreadsheet Anatomy & Data Types

Primary tool: Google Sheets

What you are learning

Rows, columns, cells, ranges, text, numbers, dates, percentages and why data types matter.

Learning objectives

- Identify cells and ranges correctly

- Recognize common data types

- Enter and format a clean table

Worked practical

Create a 20-row participant table, format headers, freeze row 1, and identify numeric vs text fields.

Source / Input	Method	Output / Check
Raw data	Apply the lesson skill	Result linked to source
Change one input	Recalculate / rerun	Confirm expected change
Control total / test	Validate	Explain the result

Guided practice

1. Recreate the lesson idea on a small example.
2. Change inputs and predict the result before recalculating.
3. Complete the supplied independent dataset in the required tool.
4. Create a control check or reconciliation.
5. Explain the result in ordinary language.

AI coaching

Ask AI to explain a concept using your own small example. Do not ask it to complete the exercise.

AI discipline

Attempt first. Use AI for explanation, hints, debugging, critique, test cases and mock questioning. Never submit output you cannot explain and independently verify.

Independent exercise

Build and format a small participant register.

Common failure modes

- Wrong grain or key.
- Formula/query/code answers a different question.
- Missing or unmatched records are silently ignored.
- Findings are not reconciled to the numbers.
- AI-generated logic is accepted without testing.

Mastery gate

[ ] I can reproduce the method without copying.
[ ] I can trace the result to the source.
[ ] I have a QA/control check.
[ ] I can explain a limitation.
[ ] I can answer an assessor's follow-up question without asking AI.